MANUSCRIPT REVIEW REPORT

Valuing diversity: an undervalued mediator of intergroup contact

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report was generated by an AI-assisted manuscript review tool. It checks formatting, referencing, language quality, and other aspects of manuscript preparation. Automated checks were supplemented by metacheck analyses, including retraction screening, DOI verification, and statistical reporting checks. The review focuses on presentation and compliance rather than scientific content. All suggestions should be verified by the authors.

OVERALL SUMMARY

This manuscript presents two studies examining whether valuing diversity mediates the effects of intergroup contact on prejudice and behavioral intentions. The writing is generally clear and the research is well-structured. However, two critical referencing issues were identified: two cited sources are missing from the reference list entirely. Several major issues include duplicated keywords, inconsistent data availability links, heading formatting inconsistencies, and a typo. Minor issues relate to the short abstract, missing ORCID IDs, and formatting details.

CRITICAL	MAJOR	MINOR	TOTAL
2	7	8	17

TOP CRITICAL ISSUES

Missing Reference: Katz & Hass (1988)

Critical

Location: Measures, Study 1 (p. 8)

Katz & Hass (1988) is cited in the Measures section (p. 8) but does not appear in the reference list. See the Referencing section below for full details and suggested reference entry.

Missing Reference: Henry & Sears (2002)

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LANGUAGE QUALITY

Overall: **B+** B+

Grammar and Syntax

Very few errors; well-constructed sentences throughout

A-

Clarity and Precision

Research questions, methods, and findings are communicated effectively

A-

Conciseness

Generally concise, though the introduction could be slightly tightened

B+

Academic Tone

Consistently formal and scholarly

A

Consistency

Some inconsistencies in heading formatting and keyword placement

B

Readability and Flow

Good transitions between sections; logical progression of arguments

A-

Strengths:

- Clear articulation of research gaps
- Effective integration of two studies
- Well-structured argumentation

Areas for improvement:

- Address heading formatting inconsistencies
- Tighten the introduction slightly
- Fix the “refering” typo

SECTION REVIEW SUMMARY

SECTION	STATUS	ISSUES
1. Title Title clarity, length, and accuracy	✓	0
2. Main Headings Heading formatting and hierarchy	✗	2
3. Title Page Author info, keywords, correspondence	✗	4
4. Abstract Abstract content and length	✗	1
5. Structure Overall manuscript organization	✓	0
6. Figures and Tables Figures/tables citations and captions	✓	0
7. Referencing Citations, reference list, DOIs	✗	5

SECTION	STATUS	ISSUES
8. Language Spelling, grammar, typos	✕	1
9. Acronyms Acronym definitions and usage	✓	0
10. Funding & Compliance Funding, ethics, preregistration	✕	2
11. Light Content Checks Open science, limitations, samples	i	Observations only
12. Statistical Reporting Statistical methods and reporting	i	Metacheck findings

DETAILED RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Title 0 issues

The title is clear, descriptive, and an appropriate length (9 words). It accurately reflects the manuscript's content and avoids abbreviations. No issues found.

2. Main Headings 1 major 1 minor

Issue 2.1 — Inconsistent heading formatting

Major

Location: The Present Research (p. 7)

```
The Present Research (centered, title case)
```

```
The present research (left-aligned, sentence case, matching other headings)
```

This heading is centered and in title case, while all other main headings (e.g., "The importance of valuing diversity", "The promise of intergroup contact") use sentence case and left alignment. Consider making the formatting consistent throughout.

Issue 2.2 — Unclear heading hierarchy

Minor

Location: Throughout

```
Mixed heading hierarchy – subsections like “Participants”, “Measures”, “Missing data and analytical approach” appear at the same visual level as main sections like “Method” and “Results”
```

```
Action: Ensure subsections are clearly visually distinguished from main sections (e.g., using bold vs. bold+larger font, or different indentation levels) to improve navigability.
```

The heading hierarchy is not always visually clear. For instance, “Participants” and “Measures” should be clearly subordinate to “Method”. Worth verifying this is handled correctly in the final typeset version.

3. Title Page

2 major 2 minor

Issue 3.1 — No corresponding author designated

Major

Location: Title page

```
No corresponding author explicitly designated
```

```
Action: Add a clear corresponding author designation, e.g., “Corresponding author: Lukas Wallrich, l.wallrich@bbk.ac.uk” as a separate line.
```

While email addresses are listed in parentheses next to author names, most journals require a clear “corresponding author” designation. This should be explicitly stated.

Issue 3.2 — Missing ORCID IDs

Minor

Location: Title page

```
No ORCID IDs included for any author
```

Action: Add ORCID iDs for all authors (e.g., as superscript links or listed below affiliations). Many journals now require or encourage ORCID identification.

Including ORCID iDs helps with author disambiguation and is increasingly required by journals.

Issue 3.3 — Duplicate keywords

Major

Location: Title page and p. 3 (after Abstract)

```
Keywords appear twice — once on the title page ("Keywords:
intergroup contact, diversity beliefs, multiculturalism, prejudice,
social integration") and again after the abstract on p. 3.
```

Action: Remove the duplicate keywords listing. Typically, keywords appear only once, either on the title page or after the abstract, depending on journal style.

Having keywords listed in two locations is redundant and may cause confusion during typesetting.

Issue 3.4 — Keyword separator format

Minor

Location: Keywords

```
Keywords are comma-separated
```

```
Keywords: intergroup contact; diversity beliefs; multiculturalism;
prejudice; social integration
```

Many journals (including those using APA style) prefer semicolon-separated keywords. Worth checking the target journal's style requirements.

4. Abstract 1 minor

Issue 4.1 — Short abstract

Minor

Location: Abstract (p. 3)

```
Abstract word count: 110 words
```

Action: Consider expanding the abstract to approximately 150–250 words. The current abstract could include more detail about the methods (e.g., sample characteristics, study designs) and specific findings (e.g., effect sizes or key statistics).

At 110 words, the abstract is shorter than the typical range for empirical psychology articles (150–300 words). A slightly longer abstract would allow for more methodological detail and specific results, which helps readers and improves discoverability.

5. Structure 0 issues

The manuscript follows a clear, logical structure with standard sections. Both studies are well-organized with Method, Results, and Discussion subsections. The General Discussion effectively synthesizes findings across studies. No issues found.

6. Figures and Tables 0 issues

All five tables and five figures (1a–1d, 2) are cited in the text in appropriate locations. Captions are descriptive and include necessary statistical notation. Figures and tables are placed at the end of the manuscript, which is standard for journal submissions. No issues found.

7. Referencing 2 critical 1 major 2 minor

AUTOMATED CROSS-REFERENCE CHECK

Issue 7.1 — Missing reference: Katz & Hass (1988)

Critical

Location: Measures, Study 1 (p. 8)

> "covered attitudes (Katz & Hass, 1988) and symbolic racism"

Action: Add the full reference for Katz, I., & Hass, R. G. (1988) to the reference list. Likely: Katz, I., & Hass, R. G. (1988). Racial ambivalence and American value conflict. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 55*(6), 893–905.

This source is cited in the text but is entirely absent from the reference list. This is a critical omission that must be corrected before submission.

Issue 7.2 — Missing reference: Henry & Sears (2002)

Critical

Location: Measures, Study 1 (p. 8)

> "symbolic racism (Henry & Sears, 2002)"

Action: Add the full reference for Henry, P. J., & Sears, D. O. (2002) to the reference list. Likely: Henry, P. J., & Sears, D. O. (2002). The Symbolic Racism 2000 Scale. *Political Psychology, 23*(2), 253–283.

This source is cited in the text but is entirely absent from the reference list. This is a critical omission that must be corrected before submission.

Issue 7.3 — Inconsistent data availability links

Major

Location: Title page (p. 1) vs. p. 2 and p. 7

```
Title page shows OSF link
“view_only=7d652e89096d4c39b8ca5de893ac384a” while p. 2 and p. 7
show “view_only=d1d6d70ce50d4d95a415f5fae756d985”
```

Action: Verify which view-only link is correct and use the same link consistently throughout the manuscript. Remove the duplicate data availability statement.

The data availability statement appears twice with different view-only access tokens. Only one should appear, and the link should be consistent. Verify that the correct, current link is used.

RETRACTION & INTEGRITY CHECK metacheck

Issue 7.4 — Retraction and integrity screening (informational)

Minor

Location: Reference list

No retracted references found. 59 references with DOIs were checked against the RetractionWatch database. No references with PubPeer comments were found.

MISSING DOIs metacheck

Issue 7.5 — Missing DOIs for several references

Minor

Location: Reference list

```
Action: Consider adding DOIs to the following references where
high-confidence matches were found:
• Corrigan et al. (2002):
https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordjournals.schbul.a006939 (score: 146,
High confidence)
• Johnston & Glasford (2018):
https://doi.org/10.1177/1368430217711770 (score: 146, High
confidence)
• Jorgensen et al. (2019):
https://doi.org/10.32614/cran.package.semtools (score: 111, High
confidence)
• Oberski (2014): https://doi.org/10.18637/jss.v057.i01 (score: 71,
Moderate confidence)
• Vertovec & Wessendorf (2010):
https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203867549 (score: 65, Moderate
confidence)
```

Adding DOIs improves reference discoverability and linking. The matches above were found via CrossRef and should be verified by the authors before adding.

8. Language

1 major

Issue 8.1 — Typo: “refering”

Major

Location: Discussion, Study 2 (p. 15)

```
“the results should be interpreted as refering to approach”
```

```
“the results should be interpreted as referring to approach”
```

“refering” is a misspelling of “referring” (double ‘r’ required).

9. Acronyms

0 issues

Acronyms are used sparingly and defined on first use (e.g., ALLBUS on p. 11, ISCED on p. 13). No issues found.

10. Funding & Compliance 2 minor

Issue 10.1 — Informal funding statement

Minor

Location: Title page (p. 1)

> "Funding declaration: There is no funding to declare."

> **Action:** Consider rewording to a more standard format: "This research received no specific grant from any funding agency in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors."

While a funding statement is present, its brevity and informal phrasing may not meet some journals' formatting requirements. metacheck Note: metacheck did not detect this funding statement, likely due to its non-standard phrasing.

Issue 10.2 — No preregistration mentioned

Minor

Location: Manuscript (general)

> No preregistration mentioned

> **Action:** If the studies were not preregistered, consider adding a brief statement acknowledging this (e.g., "Neither study was preregistered"). If preregistration was done, add a link.

Preregistration is increasingly expected for confirmatory research. The studies appear to test specific hypotheses (H1–H4), so transparency about whether these were pre-specified is valuable. metacheck metacheck found 4 OSF links but no registrations.

11. Light Content Checks Observations only

Observation 11.1 — Open Science
The manuscript provides data availability statements with OSF links and shared analysis code. This is commendable and supports reproducibility. metacheck Open data and open code were detected.

Observation 11.2 — Limitations
The limitations section (pp. 17–18) is thorough, discussing the focus on White majority perspectives, cross-sectional design limitations, reliance on behavioral intentions rather than actual behaviors, and the bidirectional relationship between contact and valuing diversity.

Observation 11.3 — Sample Description
Both samples are adequately described. Study 1: N = 217 White undergraduate psychology students (89% female, ages 18–45). Study 2: N = 2,618 German citizens from the ALLBUS 2016 survey (49.3% female, mean age 50.8). Participant exclusion criteria are clearly stated for both studies.

Observation 11.4 — Statistical Methods
Statistical methods are clearly described, including the use of SEM with full-information maximum likelihood (Study 1) and multiple imputation with survey weights (Study 2). Effect sizes are reported alongside confidence intervals throughout.

Observation 11.5 — Causal Language metacheck
Metacheck detected causal claims in the abstract (e.g., “predict less prejudice”). Given the cross-sectional design of both studies, the authors should verify that all language appropriately reflects the correlational nature of the data. The authors do note limitations around causality in the discussion, but the abstract language could be reviewed.

12. Statistical Reporting metacheck

Issue 12.1 — “Marginally significant” language

Minor

Location: Results, Study 1 (p. 9)

> “that difference was largest and marginally significant in the case of affective prejudice”

> **Action:** Consider revising to avoid “marginally significant” language. For example: “that difference was largest for affective prejudice, though the confidence interval for the difference **included zero** (Δr = .20, 95% CI [.00, .40]).”

The term “marginally significant” is widely discouraged in quantitative research because it implies that a non-significant result (p > .05) provides evidence for an effect, which inflates the Type I error rate. Results should be reported as significant or non-significant relative to the prespecified alpha level.

Informational — Statistical detection summary metacheck

12 p-values were detected in the manuscript. No APA-formatted test statistics were detected by statcheck (this is expected as the manuscript primarily reports standardized coefficients and confidence intervals rather than traditional NHST format).